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VASP-N Consultancy (Starbucks Autumn 2026 Engagement)

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Leading Big Data Business Projects

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Group: VASP-N Consultancy (Starbucks Autumn 2026 Engagement)

Reflective Learning and Discussion

How was the project managed and the workload distributed throughout the group?

Our group ran across fourteen meetings between 28 January and 3 May 2026. After the informal first session on 28 January, Vallabh was elected Team Leader unanimously at Meeting 2 and we signed our Collaborative Working Agreement. From Meeting 3 we met every Tuesday on Teams, with a few in-person sessions for the bigger moments — company finalisation, project plan, rehearsal, and recording. Tuesday was deliberate, sitting the night before our Wednesday lecture so we walked into class already on top of where we stood.

Workload split by what each person was best at. Vallabh handled coordination and the opening and closing slides. Ashutosh owned the methodology rationale. Noor kept the meeting minutes and led the segmentation narrative. Paras did the company research and visual identity. I took the slide skeleton, the KPIs on Slide 10, the data ecosystem on Slide 11, and the technology stack on Slide 12. The group went through Tuckman's (1965) forming, storming, norming and performing pretty visibly — Meeting 4 was the storming bit.

What was your personal contribution to the group? Evaluate your participation.

Most of my contribution was more structural than analytical. In Meeting 2, I set up the Google Drive folder that became our main workspace throughout the project. During Meeting 5, I introduced a fourth selection criterion — that our chosen company had to be realistically deliverable within seventeen weeks by a team of five — which helped narrow our focus. At Meeting 8, I created the sixteen-slide outline that became the foundation of our presentation, and I later took ownership of Slides 10–12. Slide 10 (Monitoring & KPIs) was the area I focused on most. In Meeting 9, the team agreed to place model-quality metrics into in-flight checkpoints at weeks 6, 8, 10, and 12, which kept the slide clear for a marketing audience while still maintaining analytical depth.

Reflecting through Gibbs' (1988) cycle, I can see that structure and organisation were where I added the most value, but also where I stayed within my comfort zone. I found the analytical side more challenging, especially justifying KPI choices. I realised I am confident organising ideas, but less confident defending technical reasoning in discussion.

Is there anything that you would do differently if you were to start the same project again?

Three things. First, draft the slide skeleton at Meeting 5, not Meeting 8 — that early outline would have given everyone a frame for their research and produced more aligned first drafts. Second, design KPIs from the recipient's perspective from day one. The right question is what the marketing team needs to see weekly, not what the model can output. Third, version-control the deck more strictly: until about Meeting 10 we had multiple working copies in the Drive, and a single canonical version would have avoided two small merge issues during assembly. The wider lesson is that the engineering discipline I would apply to code applies to documents too.

References

- Gibbs, G. (1988) *Learning by Doing: A Guide to Teaching and Learning Methods*. Oxford: Further Education Unit, Oxford Polytechnic.
- Tuckman, B. W. (1965) 'Developmental sequence in small groups', *Psychological Bulletin*, 63(6), pp. 384–399.